Test Tube Lives

By Jason Sheets

SANDY: **(Pg 125-130)** Well, I thought it was fun!

MICHAEL: I don't care what you say…movies aren't meant to be over three hours!

SANDY: True. Thanks for being with me tonight. It was really important that I didn't spend tonight alone. (A beat) You know. One year ago tonight was supposed to be –

MICHAEL: One year ago tonight – your wedding.

SANDY: Yeah. So anyway, thanks. I didn't want to obsess over it.

MICHAEL: You OK?

SANDY: Yeah. I still know it was the right thing not to get married, but here I am. 35. I always said if I'm 35 and still single I'd run away and be a nun. It's lonely. I know – you can't always relate. I mean, you've got Nate and you always have someone there.

MICHAEL: It's nice.

SANDY: Meanwhile, I'm realizing that I'm getting too old to be the "new look" news-anchor. Too old to find a husband. Too old to have a baby.

MICHAEL: 35 isn't that old. And some things you just have to accept. I've accepted I'm not having children, either.

SANDY: Well, you could.

MICHAEL: Sure, I could adopt. We both could –

SANDY: Or we could (pause)

MICHAEL: We could what?

SANDY: Or we could.

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INTRODUCTION

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MICHAEL: Sandy, are you serious?

SANDY: You always said with your looks and my brains…

MICHAEL: Whoa – the last thing this would needs is a kid looking like me running around! Besides, Nate probably would have problems with the creation of this wonderchild.

SANDY: We wouldn't have to actually do it. These doctors now –

MICHAEL: OK, fine. But you want me? Me? To be the father?

SANDY: You're my best friend.

MICHAEL: Yes.

SANDY: We stick together no matter what.

MICHAEL: Yes.

SANDY: You're gay, so that means no romantic attachment.

MICHAEL: Sure, but –

SANDY: And I know you. You want to be a father, don't you?

MICHAEL: I never'd really much thought about it.

SANDY: C'mon.

MICHAEL: OK, maybe once.

SANDY: C'mon, I saw you watch Three Men and a Baby

MICHAEL: Yes, and I laughed. You know why? They were awful parents!

SANDY: No, they cared. They just needed a little help. I'm that help. Michael, I'll raise the child. You can be as little or as big a part of his

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MICHAEL: Or her

SANDY: Life.

MICHAEL: Don't you want love? A husband? All the –

SANDY: I don't want give up on love, Michael. But there's no window for love. There is a window for having a child. I only need one. One. A boy. A girl. I don't care. I have just always wanted to be a mother.

MICHAEL: (long pause) I'll need to ask Nate.

SANDY: Of course. Will you?

MICHAEL: Yeah, I will.

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SANDY: (on the telephone) So what'd he say?

MICHAEL: Don't you think I should come over so we can –

SANDY: No. What'd he say???

MICHAEL: He's cool with it.

SANDY: Really?

MICHAEL: Yeah, he's cool with it.

SANDY: Are you?

MICHAEL: Sandy, this is big.

SANDY: Are you cool with it?

MICHAEL: Yeah, truthfully I went shopping this morning. How do you feel about pastels?

SANDY: I knew you'd love this!

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MICHAEL: I still think we're crazy.

SANDY: That's OK. So do I. (playing cards)

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MICHAEL: Nothing like a game of crazy eights to calm the nerves.

SANDY: I know – not much strategy to worry about.

MICHAEL: I feel as if my life is out of control…

SANDY: But it's a good feeling isn't it?

MICHAEL: Yeah, it is. I keep imagining what it'll be like to have a child call me dad".

SANDY: Never thought it'd happen, did you?

MICHAEL: Truthfully, no. Gay men kind of give up on having it all.

SANDY: But now…

MICHAEL: Now, I've got it all. Sandy, I'm so excited.

SANDY: You don't think we're warping the child by giving him two fathers and a mother?

MICHAEL: I think in the 1990s most children need three parents.

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SANDY: Wow, I had no clue how expensive this whole process is! A 15% success rate and the time it takes! Let's just hope your boys are potent!

MICHAEL: Can we refrain from the talk of my boys?

SANDY: Sure, I'm sorry, I just had no idea –

MICHAEL: We went shopping too soon?

SANDY: No – the power of positive thinking, right?

MICHAEL: Right. Wow, and just last week I was thinking of tearing down the basketball hoop.

SANDY: Better leave it up he

MICHAEL: Or she

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SANDY: May like it.

MICHAEL: Sure. So where do we begin?

SANDY: We test your boys and your blood – I mean you go in for –

MICHAEL: Don't worry, I get the drift.

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SANDY: So, why'd you call? I got your message at work. You never call me there. I –

MICHAEL: Have you talked to the doctor?

SANDY: No.

MICHAEL: Sandy, I've changed my mind, I can't do this.

SANDY: What?

MICHAEL: You heard me. I said I can't do this.

SANDY: What do you mean? Is this your idea of a joke? You give me the OK, go shopping for baby things, go down for testing, put up with me, and then –

MICHAEL: And then nothing. I just can't, OK? Look, I gotta go.

SANDY: Like hell. You're going to stay, and Michael, as my friend of 15 years, you're going to tell me. You're free to back out, but you sure as hell are going to tell me why.

MICHAEL: What does it matter?

SANDY: Is it Nate.

MICHAEL: No, no of course not. He doesn't even know I'm here.

SANDY: Is it your job? You know you can still travel –

MICHAEL: Sandy, will you stop?

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SANDY: No, I won't stop. I want a baby. You'd be the greatest father in the world, and I want to know why!

MICHAEL: I can't.

SANDY: Why?

MICHAEL: I –

SANDY: Why???

MICHAEL: Cause I've got AIDS. OK??? My boys are fine, my blood has AIDS. I can't father your damn kid because they don't approve of AIDS babies, OK? I can't father our child because I'm gonna die. I'm gonna…(cries)

SANDY: (pause) My God, Michael, how did this happen?

MICHAEL: I haven't been with Nate forever.

SANDY: But Michael

MICHAEL: Look, I gotta go. Nate needs a test, I need to tell him. I'm sorry about the baby. I mean I am so sorry.

SANDY: Michael –

MICHAEL: (waves)

SANDY: I'll call you, OK?

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SANDY: (on phone) Heya, Nate. Is Michael there> Oh, OK. No, he should be at the doctors. Congrats on your test, by the way. Um, I just wanted to see when I could drop off some books. I found some material on AIDS. You know, they've really made a lot of breakthroughs…

MICHAEL: Hi, Sandy.

SANDY: I thought you were –

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MICHAEL: I'm here. Just not taking calls at the moment.

SANDY: But you're taking mine.

MICHAEL: Yeah, I'm taking yours. So, what –

SANDY: Michael, I just wanted to call to tell you thank you.

MICHAEL: For what?

SANDY: For making me realize. I've spent all this time obsessing over family. Family. Family. Never for once realizing, you and Nate are it. I've got a family.

MICHAEL: Thanks Sandy.

SANDY: And now a family member is sick. So it's my job to cheer you up. May I interest you in a fierce battle of crazy eights?

MICHAEL: Sure can.

SANDY: Good, I'll be right over.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

IL State Qualifier
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